



Google's OS

Just A Chrome Polish or Is There Some Metal Inside Too?

Google has announced the development of the Chrome OS. For the first time, this search engine giant has taken its archrival Microsoft head-on. But the emergence of Google as an omnipresent player could also have a flip side.

*H*ow can you be the lord of the sea without your own ship? This is what Google, a company that started out with a search engine, then entered domain after domain, before becoming the tallest giant of the Internet Age, has realised.

All of Google's businesses are in the online world—if there were no Internet or access to Google services, it would mean no business for the Mountain View company. The only interface to Google services has always been a browser. Microsoft saw Google as its biggest threat on this turf, so there was little chance that Microsoft's IE (Instant Exploiter)

would ever give Google an easy ride on the Internet Highway.

Google did make friends with Firefox and others, but for how long can you take a ride on rented cars? So Google launched its very own Chrome browser, which like most Google services is still in the beta stage and not very efficient on the GNU/Linux platform. But the next problem Google faced was how to entice users of Windows or a Mac to the world of Chrome. So it decided to develop its own operating system as well.

While analysts are busy studying the impact this OS will have on the market, industry and FOSS leaders have refused to